

Fences

Objectives

By the end of this Unit the student will be able to

1. Identify the protagonist and explain why he, rather than any of the other three major characters, is the protagonist.
2. Identify the antagonist(s) of the play from the perspectives of Troy, Rose, Lyons, and Cory.
3. State the literal significance of the play's title, relating it to specific events in the play.
4. State the metaphorical significance of the play's title, relating it to specific events in the play.
5. Recognize shifts in the metaphorical significance of the play's title as seen by Troy, Rose, Lyons, and Cory.
6. Explain the source of Troy's disillusionment and his rationale for committing adultery.
7. Identify and explain the function of a dramatic foil and discuss dramatic foils in the play.
8. Assess whether Troy's failures are a result of his own bad decisions or that of a flawed society.
9. Explain the role of racial prejudice, both real and imagined, in the play.
10. Explain the function of baseball as a symbol in the play.
11. Explain the significance of Gabriel's delusions and how they symbolize hope for the future.
12. Understand the concept of catharsis and explain how Rose's response to Troy's affair strengthens her character.
13. Recognize patterns in the lives of the Maxson men and compare Lyons and Cory to Troy and to each other.
14. Trace the play's exposition, conflict, climax, and denouement.
15. Identify examples of situational irony in the play.
16. Explain the importance of humor in the play, and cite some examples of its use.
17. Discuss the use of songs and music in the play.